FarmLink Nigeria Comprehensive Product Requirements Document (PRD)

Executive Summary

FarmLink Nigeria is a digital marketplace designed to connect farmers, livestock producers, and food vendors directly with buyers across Nigeria.

The platform allows agricultural producers to list products while buyers can discover, compare, and purchase fresh produce safely.

The system includes secure payment infrastructure, seller verification, buyer reviews, and delivery confirmation. Payments are held in escrow and released only when buyers confirm successful delivery. This model builds trust in online agricultural commerce.

FarmLink aims to solve a major inefficiency in Nigeria's agricultural supply chain: farmers lack direct access to markets while buyers lack trusted sources of fresh farm produce.

Problem Statement

Nigeria's agricultural sector faces several structural problems:

1. Limited Market Access for Farmers

Many farmers rely on middlemen who reduce their profits and control pricing.

2. Lack of Trust in Online Food Purchases

Buyers are hesitant to purchase agricultural products online due to fraud risks and unreliable delivery.

3. Fragmented Marketplaces

Most farm products are currently sold through informal channels such as roadside markets or social media platforms.

4. Lack of Price Transparency

Farmers and buyers often lack accurate data on market pricing, leading to underpricing or exploitation.

Proposed Solution

FarmLink Nigeria provides a centralized online marketplace where farmers and food vendors can list agricultural products and buyers can purchase them securely.

Key elements of the solution include:

• Verified farmer profiles

• Product listing and search functionality

• Secure escrow payment system

• Buyer review and rating system

• Location-based product discovery

• Order tracking and dispute resolution

The platform creates a structured digital market for agricultural commerce.

Product Vision

To become Nigeria's most trusted digital infrastructure for agricultural commerce by connecting millions of farmers directly with consumers and businesses.

Target Users

Primary Users:

• Crop farmers

• Poultry farmers

• Livestock owners

• Fish farmers

• Vegetable growers

• Food vendors

Secondary Users:

• Households

• Restaurants

• Hotels

• Supermarkets

• Bulk food buyers

• Food distributors

Core Platform Features

User Accounts

• Buyer and seller registration

• Email verification using one-time codes

• Secure authentication

Seller Tools

• Seller store profiles

• Product listing and inventory management

• Order management dashboard

• Sales analytics

Buyer Tools

• Product search and filtering

• Secure checkout

• Order tracking

• Reviews and ratings

Trust Features

• Verified seller badges

• Escrow payment protection

• Dispute resolution system

• Transparent seller profiles

Future Features

AI Price Insights

AI-powered tools will provide farmers with market price insights based on demand trends and location data. The AI suggests price ranges but does not enforce pricing.

Bulk Marketplace

Restaurants and large buyers can post bulk purchase requests and farmers can submit supply offers.

Farm Verification Program

Physical or documentation-based farm verification to increase buyer trust.

Harvest Alerts

Farmers can announce newly harvested produce to attract buyers quickly.

Farm Map

Interactive map showing farms and products near buyers.

Revenue Model

FarmLink will generate revenue through:

Transaction Commission

The platform charges a 5 percent commission on every completed order.

Seller Advertising

Sellers can promote their products using banner advertisements and featured listings.

Vendor Subscription Plans

Optional subscription tiers that provide advanced analytics, product promotions, and marketplace visibility.

Featured Listings

Sellers can pay to promote products in top search positions.

Advertisement System

The platform supports sponsored advertisements in multiple locations:

Homepage Banner Ads

Large promotional banners shown on the homepage.

Sidebar Advertisements

Ads displayed on product and browsing pages.

Featured Product Promotions

Highlighted listings placed at the top of product search results.

Sellers apply through their dashboard and advertisements are approved by administrators before being published.

Technology Architecture

Frontend

Next.js framework with TailwindCSS for responsive design.

Backend

Node.js with Express API services.

Database

PostgreSQL relational database.

Storage

Cloud-based image storage.

Payments

Secure payment gateway integration.

Hosting

Cloud hosting infrastructure for scalability.

The architecture is designed to remain cost■efficient while supporting future growth.

Security and Trust

Security measures include:

• Email verification

• Password hashing

• Secure payment verification

• Role■based access control

• Escrow payment protection

• Fraud detection monitoring

These measures help maintain platform integrity and user trust.

Go■to■Market Strategy

Phase 1: Farmer Onboarding

Recruit the first group of farmers and suppliers to list their products.

Phase 2: Marketplace Liquidity

Ensure sufficient product supply to attract buyers.

Phase 3: Buyer Acquisition

Market the platform as a trusted way to buy fresh farm products.

Phase 4: Expansion

Expand to additional regions and introduce bulk purchasing features.

Market Opportunity

Nigeria has one of the largest agricultural markets in Africa.

Key opportunities include:

• Millions of smallholder farmers seeking market access

• Rapid growth of digital commerce

• Increasing demand for fresh food delivery

• Large restaurant and hospitality industries

FarmLink aims to digitize agricultural trade and capture value from this growing market.

Product Roadmap

Phase 1 (MVP)

User accounts, product listings, escrow payments, order management, and reviews.

Phase 2

Seller verification, advertising tools, and improved analytics.

Phase 3

Bulk marketplace, AI pricing insights, and logistics integrations.

Phase 4

Mobile applications and regional expansion.

Key Success Metrics

Platform growth will be measured using:

• Number of registered farmers

• Number of active buyers

• Monthly transaction volume

• Order completion rate

• Seller retention rate

• Buyer satisfaction ratings

Long■Term Vision

FarmLink aims to become a foundational digital infrastructure for agricultural commerce in Africa.

By improving market access, transparency, and trust, the platform can significantly increase farmer income while making fresh food more accessible to consumers.